# 15th Annual Fixed Income and Financial Institutions (FIFI) • October 30–31, 2026

Darla Moore School of Business, University of South Carolina

*Presenting authors are shown in italics.*

**Friday (October 30, 2026)**

## 7:45 AM Breakfast & Registration (Room 331)

## 9:30 AM Opening Remarks (Room 334)

**Speaker: Gregory R. Niehaus, Interim Dean of the Darla Moore School of Business and Professor of Finance**

## 10:00 AM Deposits and Bankers (Room 334)

Session Chair: Hugh Hoikwang Kim

**The Declining Role of Deposits in Credit Creation**
Naz Koont, Stanford University
*Stefan Walz, Boston College*
Discussant: Stefan Lewellen, Pennsylvania State University

**Blocking the Credit Chain: Cryptocurrencies, Deposits, and Bank Loan Growth**
*Allen N. Berger, University of South Carolina*
Jiarui Guo, University of International Business and Economics
Stephen A. Karolyi, George Mason University
Leili Pour Rostami, University of Massachusetts Boston
Discussant: Jinyuan Zhang, University of California, Los Angeles

**Organization of Human Capital in Corporate Lending**
Young Soo Jang, Pennsylvania State University
Vrinda Mittal, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
*Zirui Song, Massachusetts Institute of Technology*
Discussant: Maddalena Ronchi, Northwestern University

## 10:00 AM Corporate Bond Markets (Room 324)

Session Chair: Eric Powers

**Demand Elasticity in the Primary Market for Corporate Bonds**
Edith Hotchkiss, Boston College
Liying Wang, University of Nebraska–Lincoln
*Yijia (Eddie) Zhao, University of Massachusetts Boston*
Discussant: Manav Chaudhary, London School of Economics

**Multimarket Contact and the Cost of Trading Corporate Bonds**
Marco Grotteria, London Business School
Andreas C. Rapp, Federal Reserve Board
Ruslan Sverchkov, University of Warwick
*Ram Yamarthy, Federal Reserve Board*
Discussant: Or Shachar, Federal Reserve Bank of New York

**Predictive Information in Corporate Bonds for the Equity Premium**
*Sophia Zhengzi Li, Rutgers University*
Peixuan Yuan, Hong Kong Baptist University
Guofu Zhou, Washington University in St. Louis
Discussant: Varun Sharma, Indiana University

## 12:30 PM Keynote Speech & Lunch (Sonoco Pavilion)

**Keynote Speaker: Uday Rajan**
David B. Hermelin Professor of Business Administration and Professor of Finance, University of Michigan

## 2:30 PM Nonbank Intermediaries (Room 334)

Session Chair: Sergey Tsyplakov

**Credit Commitments by Nonbanks**
Jing Huang, Texas A&M University
*David X. Xu, Southern Methodist University*
Discussant: Sharjil Haque, Federal Reserve Board

**The Fragility of Semi-Liquid Private Credit Funds**
*Chuck Fang, Drexel University*
Itay Goldstein, University of Pennsylvania
Yao Zeng, University of Pennsylvania
Discussant: Samuel Rosen, Temple University

**Prime Broker Credit Supply and the Stock Market: Evidence on Hedge Fund Transmission**
Daniel Barth, Federal Reserve Board
*Nicholas Zarra, Federal Reserve Board*
Discussant: Philippe van der Beck, Harvard University

## 2:30 PM Benchmarks, Bond Funds, and Short Squeezes (Room 324)

Session Chair: Ai He

**The Real Cost of Benchmarking**
*Christian Kontz, University of Notre Dame*
Sebastian Hanson, Citadel
Discussant: Yao Deng, University of Connecticut

**Credit Where It's Not Due: Misbenchmarking by Active Bond Funds**
Caitlin Dannhauser, Villanova University
Michele Dathan, Federal Reserve Board
*Michael Young, University of Missouri*
Qifei Zhu, Texas A&M University
Discussant: Yang Sun, Brandeis University

**Short Squeezes in the Corporate Bond Market**
Biswajit Chakraborty, University of Kansas
Gjergji Cici, University of Kansas
Mohammad Ghaderi, University of Kansas
*Angel Tengulov, University of Kansas*
Discussant: Jack Bao, University of Delaware

## 5:15 PM Reception (5th floor of DMSB)

**Saturday (October 31, 2026)**

## 7:30 AM Breakfast (Room 331)

## 8:30 AM Regulatory Capital and Risk-Taking (Room 334)

Session Chair: Konstantin von Beringe

**Capital Insulation and Bank Risk-Taking: Evidence from Corporate Bond Portfolios**
Emilio Bisetti, Hong Kong University of Science and Technology
Stephen A. Karolyi, George Mason University
Arthur Luo, Office of the Comptroller of the Currency
*Ahyan Panjwani, Federal Reserve Board*
Discussant: James Vickery, Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia

**Rating Without Market Discipline**
Xuelin Li, Columbia University
*Sangmin S. Oh, Columbia University*
Giacomo Ricciardi, Columbia University
Discussant: Chotibhak (Pab) Jotikasthira, Southern Methodist University

## 8:30 AM Municipal Bonds: Underwriting and Valuation (Room 324)

Session Chair: Wendi Du

**Breaking the Bond: The Effect of Banker Turnover on Municipal Bonds**
*Natasha Boreyko, University of Virginia*
Discussant: John Hackney, University of Arkansas

**Market Value of U.S. Universities**
Benjamin Bennett, Texas Christian University
Jaewon Choi, Seoul National University
Chanik Jo, Chinese University of Hong Kong
*Yoshio Nozawa, University of Toronto*
Discussant: Matteo Binfarè, University of Missouri

## 10:00 AM Break

## 10:30 AM Private Capital (Room 334)

Session Chair: Madeline Scanlon

**Human Capital in Venture Capital: Evidence From 100,000 Venture Capitalists**
*Blake Jackson, Ohio State University*
Ilya A. Strebulaev, Stanford University
Discussant: Vladimir Mukharlyamov, DePaul University

**Shock Transmission Through Bank-Nonbank Linkages: Evidence from Private Credit**
*Manasa Gopal, Georgia Institute of Technology*
Camelia Minoiu, Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta
Veronika Penciakova, Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta
Discussant: Francesco Beraldi, Duke University

## 10:30 AM Duration (Room 324)

Session Chair: Aaron Mora

**Bye Bye Beta: Deposit Duration with Fixed Spreads**
*Robert Rogers, University of Chicago*
Discussant: Xu Lu, University of Washington

**The US Treasury's Biggest Short: Duration in the Shadows**
*Ljubica Georgievska, CUNEF Universidad and New York University*
Stefano Pegoraro, University of Notre Dame
Anthony Saunders, New York University
Discussant: Filippo Cavaleri, University of Toronto